

Emacs support for 🍏 AppleScript

Description	Keystroke	Function	Note		
AppleScript Support	PEL provides basic support for macOS AppleScript. 🔧 PEL enables AppleScript editing and execution support when the pel-use-applescript user option is set to t. - PEL provides help for editing AppleScript files via the 📦 apples-mode external package. 🍏 On macOS systems, PEL also provide a key hydra you can use to narrate any text in buffer out-loud using macOS synthesized voices and commands to execute AppleScript commands and programs. These would normally only be supported by Emacs running in Graphics mode, but PEL provides a simple functions to use them inside Emacs running in Terminal (TTY) mode as well. - When editing an AppleScript file (a file with the .applescript or .sct extension) the buffer is automatically placed in apples-mode and the <f12> key is used as the mode-specific prefix . The <f11> SPC is the global mode prefix for the AppleScript commands.				
Last updated on:	2026-09-19				
Open this PDF file. See also: 📖 Help/Info	<f11> SPC a <f1> <f12> <f1>	(pel-help-pdf &optional OPEN-WEB-PAGE)	Open the 📖 AppleScript local PDF. With C-u , M-- , M- -1 or C- -1 prefix: open the remote GitHub hosted PDF instead. If the pel-flip-help-pdf-arg user-option is set it's the other way around.		
Customize PEL AppleScript support. See also:🔧 Customize	<f11> SPC a <f2> <f12> <f2>	(pel-customize-pel &optional OTHER-WINDOW)	Open the PEL customize group(s) for the current context: applescript. Use this to open to change PEL user option variables the activate and control the various Apple script features such as the name of the narrator voice. When a prefix argument (like C-u) opens the buffer inside another window.		
Customize Emacs built-in AppleScript support See also:🔧 Customize	<f11> SPC a <f3> <f12> <f3>	(pel-customize-library &optional OTHER-WINDOW)	Customize Emacs apples group. - When a prefix argument (like C-u) opens the buffer inside another window. - Group belonging to files that have not yet been loaded are normally not accessible in Emacs and via the customize-group command. PEL, however, attempts to locate the file that defines a non-loaded customization group and will prompt you for loading the file if it finds it.		
Open an AppleScript scratchpad buffer	<f11> SPC a s <f12> s	(apples-open-scratch)	Open scratch buffer for AppleScript editing. It is rendered properly and allows you to write AppleScript code without committing it to a file.		
🍏 Text narration	🍏 On macOS systems only, PEL provides a set of commands to narrate text taken from - a prompt or, - directly from the current buffer at point: - word - sentence - paragraph - region. 🔧 📦 With PEL user option pel-use-hydra set to t, PEL activates the hydra external package and also creates a Hydra set of keys to help speed up narration. These keys are identified in the table below. - To start this Hydra, hit the <f7> S keys, then hit one of the following keys once or several times. - The keys that are in the PEL window hydra are all identified below with a <f7>S prefix, but when pel-use-hydra is set to t, after typing <f7> S once, you can hit several other window hydra keys without typing the prefix again. - While the PEL narrate hydra is active, you can also type other commands; the hydra will stay active. You can, for example, select a region and then type R to read it aloud. - To cancel the Hydra hit the <f7> key again. - A snapshot of the narrate hydra menu that shows up in the mini buffer area as soon as one of its keys is pressed is shown below. ⚠️ 🙌 If the pel-use-hydra is nil, then you must type the prefix before every narration command. Using the narration hydra is easier and more flexible. - The narration commands available are shown below. - The narrate hydra includes some navigation commands to help move around while being in narration mode. These are only showing inside the narrate hydra help menu. - The name of the PEL window hydra commands are not listed below. They all have a name that begins with pel-Σsay/ and ends with the same name as the command function listed in the Function column. For example, pel-Σsay/pel-say is bound to <f7> S t. 🙌 When processing text, PEL filters out the comments strings for the buffer's major mode. It also performs a set of text translation to help the narration. These are currently not configurable.				
🍏 PEL Narration Hydra	Read ----- w: word s: sentence p: paragraph R: region	Repeat ----- r: last word	Type ----- t: at prompt	Move to ----- b: previous word n: next word B: previous sentence N: next sentence	End ----- <f7>: cancel
Narrate the text entered at prompt	<f7> S t	(pel-say TEXT &optional FILTER-CHARS-REGEXP)	Say TEXT out-loud. Prompts for the text. - Use the Apple osascript to narrate the text using synthesized voice. - Quotes are not allowed inside the text. - The optional FILTER-CHARS-REGEXP can be used to exclude text from the narration.		
Read the word at point out-loud	<f7> S w	(pel-say-word)	Say word at point out-loud and move to next word.		
Read the sentence at point out-loud	<f7> S s	(pel-say-sentence)	Say sentence at point out-loud and move to next sentence.		
Read the paragraph at point out-loud	<f7> S p	(pel-say-paragraph)	Say paragraph at point out-loud and move to next paragraph.		
Read the selected region of text out-loud	<f7> S R	(pel-say-region START END)	Say text between region's START end END out-loud.		